In the IMF, Washington agreed to a generous package of voting shares and an ED position when Russia returned to the Fund in the early 1990s after the Soviet collapse. In the G7, the Bill Clinton administration favored including Russia and enlarging the group to the G8 as another anchor to Yeltsin's government. Although Russians blame the United States for taking advantage of Russia's retreat and weakness and for ruinous economic advice, its polarized politics and partially reformed economy were the principal causes of its economic problems.[120] However, one of the important American mistakes in the IMF was a failure to find the right balance between support and discipline.

It took two major shocks—the 1991 collapse of the Soviet Union and the 1998 currency shock and Russian default—for Russian leaders to learn the importance of sound macroeconomic policy and large foreign currency reserves, particularly for a state dependent on energy exports. Along the way, Putin and Medvedev came to appreciate the value of expert assessments from liberal Russian economists, as well as from the world's foremost multilateral and private institutions such as the World Bank, IMF, and Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD); Western investment banks such as Goldman Sachs and Deutsche Bank; and management consulting firms, including McKinsey and the Boston Consulting Group, whose staff have been contracted to support a wide range of state projects, such as improving Russian business practices. The quality of information and analysis about the Russian economy arguably has never been higher or more widely available, although Russia's rulers predictably appreciate sound macroeconomic advice more than reform plans that require changes in institutions that buttress the Russian political order.[121]

Sanctions have simultaneously strengthened the voice of nationalist economists, such as Sergei Glazyev, who see the West as seeking the destruction of Russia while weakening the practical utility of their economic arguments.[122] Their antimarket, statist, protectionist agenda favors greater state investment in technology and defense industry, as well as a reorientation of reserves to BRICS currencies.[123] However, despite sustained support for defense and some apparent politically motivated shake-ups, including the arrest in November 2016 of the liberal Economic Development Minister Aleksei Uliukaev, Putin has adhered to prudent